President

Matt Cook

Burley Idaho West Stake Conference
November 8, 2026

Guiding. Directing. Comforting. *Constant.*

What a prophet of God says we will need to survive spiritually in the days ahead.

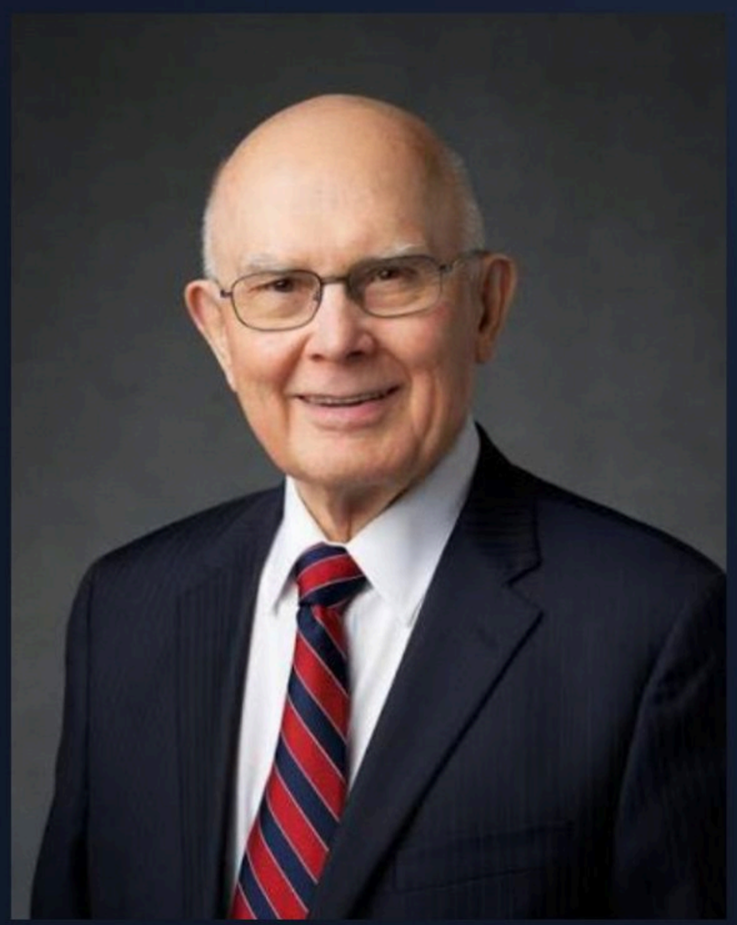


In his first public address as President of the Church, President Dallin H. Oaks repeated a warning given by his predecessor, President Russell M. Nelson.

“When the words of prophets seem repetitive, that should rivet our attention …”

President Henry B. Eyring

“Finding Safety in Counsel,” April 1997 General Conference



President Dallin H. Oaks

“Coming Closer to Jesus Christ,” BYU Devotional, February 10, 2026

“I feel to emphasize the warning President Russell M. Nelson issued us: that ‘in coming days, it will not be possible to survive spiritually without the *guiding, directing, comforting, and constant* influence of the Holy Ghost.’”

President Dallin H. Oaks

"Coming Closer to Jesus Christ," BYU Devotional, February 10, 2026

"One of the many reasons you will need the constant influence of the Holy Ghost is that you live in a season in which the adversary has become so effective at disguising truth that *if you don't have the Holy Ghost, you will be deceived.* Many obstacles lie ahead. The distractions will be many."

The guiding, directing influence of the Holy Ghost

Elder David A. Bednar has taught:

"The overwhelming majority of impressions and revelations you ever receive will come in the course of you being a good boy or a good girl, honoring your covenants, keeping your commandments, and you will become an instrument in the hands of God and He will take you where you need to be so you can do what He wants you to do and *much of the time you'll never know that it's happening that way.*"

Elder David A. Bednar
Remarks at the Provo Missionary Training Center (transcribed)

The guiding, directing influence of the Holy Ghost

The Holy Ghost does more than guide our path. I believe the Lord also directs our lives in ways that remind us *He sees us and knows us.* Through tender mercies, He shows us that He is in charge, and He lets us see His hand in the direction of our lives.





I saw this on a trip to Cambodia. More than 40 years ago, two little boys met in a refugee camp in Thailand after escaping the ravages of war. Decades later, after each had found the restored gospel of Jesus Christ, my wife, my son, and I witnessed their sweet reunion as brothers in the gospel, in the jungles of Cambodia.

The comforting influence of the Holy Ghost

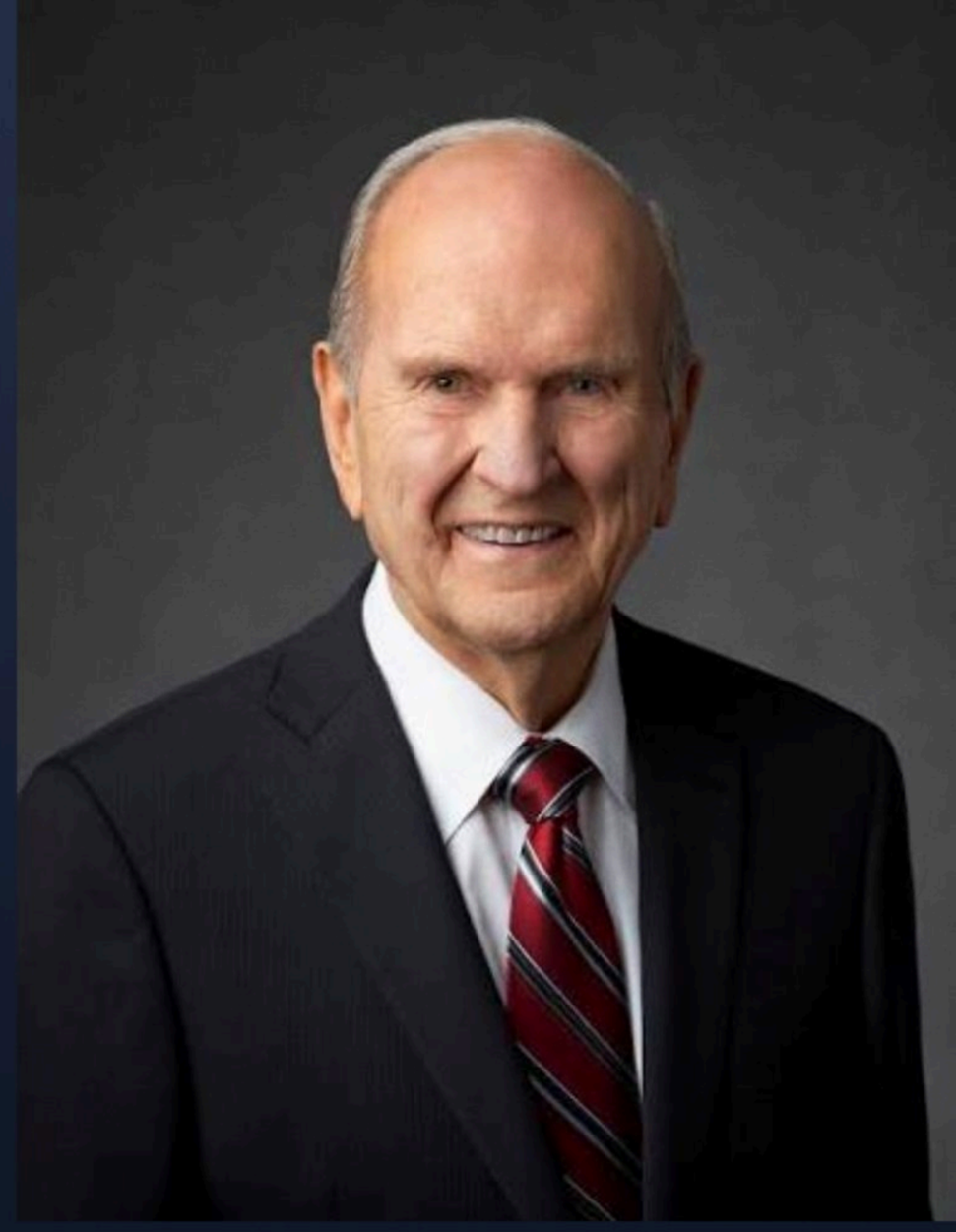
Some trials seem impossible to overcome. In those moments, the Holy Ghost brings comfort like nothing else can. I have felt that comfort in my own life, and I have watched it sustain countless members of our stake through nearly insurmountable challenges. Many have stood fast only because of the comforting influence of the Holy Ghost. *That comfort is real, and it is beyond description.*

The constant influence of the Holy Ghost

I invite each of us to *"choose to do the spiritual work"* required to have the Holy Ghost as our constant companion. Yes, it is a choice. And yes, it is work. We must set aside the distractions that bombard our lives and take intentional steps, every day, to invite the Spirit in.

Quoting **President Russell M. Nelson**
"Revelation for the Church, Revelation for Our Lives," April 2018 General Conference

"Nothing opens the heavens quite like the combination of



1 increased purity,

2 exact obedience,

3 earnest seeking,

4 daily feasting on the words of Christ in the Book of Mormon, and

5 regular time committed to temple and family history work."

President Russell M. Nelson
"Revelation for the Church, Revelation for Our Lives," April 2018 General Conference